

Dear Editor, dear Dr. Tsai,

We are submitting the second revision of **IoT-70170-2026**, “Congestion-Aware Joint Charging-Station Placement, Capacity, and Swarm-UAV Trajectory Design for Age-Optimal Data Collection”. The title, the problem, and the contributions are unchanged.

We must begin with an apology. Two reviewers reported that our previous response letter did not answer their comments. They were right, and the cause was ours. The first-round decision letter carried five reviewers’ comments in the body of the e-mail and one reviewer’s comments as an attachment. Only the attachment reached our working copy, so the previous letter answered seven points while the reviewers had raised forty-six. Nothing was declined and nothing was judged unimportant; the material was never collected. The accompanying response letter now answers **every numbered point of every reviewer from both rounds**: forty-six from the first round and eight from the second, fifty-four in total. It is generated from a ledger with one row per comment, so its completeness can be checked by counting rather than taken on trust. Because the reviewer numbering changed between rounds, every old point is numbered by its *first-round* reviewer and both numbers appear in each heading.

Three changes alter what the paper claims, and we list them here rather than leave them to be found:

- **$M=12$ is no longer described as the optimal swarm size.** A reviewer asked us to re-check that claim under the actual placement and port split, and the check contradicted it: the table we had cited gives $M^*=12$ for one station with four ports, whereas the setup splits four ports over two stations. Sweeping M under the real configuration gives $M^*=16$. We keep $M=12$ as a fixed and neutral operating point, note that it costs the proposed method 3.9%, and repeat the entire comparison with every method at its own optimum, where the advantages are essentially unchanged.
- **The feasibility claim held only at the smallest field size.** While answering a request to report the violation of every constraint, we found that our own statement that the returned designs are “feasible with margin to spare” was measured at a 5 km field, whereas the main comparison runs at 15 km, where the recharge-reachability constraint is in fact relaxed. The paper now reports the field sizes at which that constraint can and cannot be met, states that the large-field results hold under an idealized-reachability assumption, and turns the finding into a provisioning guideline. No reviewer raised this; we found it and we report it.
- **The claims about the queueing model are narrower.** The agreement between the analytic model and the simulator under matched assumptions is now described as a sanity check of the implementation rather than as validation of the model, and the “conservative upper bound” language is replaced by an empirical overestimate on the configurations tested. To answer the underlying concern we applied one *common* near-deterministic simulator to the final design of all five methods: the ordering is identical to the analytic ordering and the proposed design wins on 20 of 20 seeds.

Two procedural notes. First, all results in this version were regenerated on a single documented machine, re-run from the exact commit that was submitted last time; of 77 previously reported quantities, 69 are bit-identical and eight moved in the third significant digit, with no conclusion changed. Second, the figures were redrawn at the true column width after we measured that several were being scaled down on placement, leaving text as small as 6.5 pt; all figures now print at 9.3 pt or larger.

All changes are marked in the accompanying highlighted PDF, in blue for added text and dark red for deleted text.

Every reported quantity is generated from the artifact by script, and a single command reproduces

the measurements, recording a SHA-256 digest per result file so a rerun can be checked rather than trusted: <https://github.com/haodpsut/swarm-uav-aoi-congestion>.

We are grateful to the reviewers for their patience, and particularly to those who told us plainly that their comments had gone unanswered.

Sincerely,

Truong Duy Dinh, on behalf of all authors